

**Among Us 2 cancelled**

Developers of Among Us confirmed that the sequel has been cancelled to better focus on the original. <http://digit.in/oct20-49>

**Mass Effect Remastered delayed**

The remastered edition of the Mass Effect trilogy will launch in early 2021 instead of this October. <http://digit.in/oct20-50>

Max covidocy



Credit: I. Salci / Shutterstock.com

Mask up, it's not over yet

Aditya Madanapalle | aditya@digit.in

**CORONASPEEK**

The pandemic is by no means over, but easing restrictions around the

world means that some people continue to threaten the safety of themselves and others by finding new ways of being stupid. This includes rat-lickers who do not take the measures of hygiene and social distancing, or those who deny that the pandemic situation is as grave as it is, referring to it as a scamdemic, or the anti-maskers or masktards who advocate the unscientific position that masks do not really help prevent the spread of the disease. There is now even an Urdu word for such people, covakoofs. One can only LOLUMM at them, which stands for laughing out

loud under my mask. Those who do advocate the wearing of masks, are now called maskivists. The science of the pandemic has already gotten polarised, less than a year into the outbreak. Researchers are still only finding out about the full effects of the disease, and Long Covid is a term referred to the debilitating and long term affects of the virus, the so called long haulers who continue to suffer from respiratory problems, fatigue, and compromised immune systems months after “recovering” from the disease. Meanwhile people are finding new ways of “officing”, going beyond their homes as alternative workplaces and occupying cafes or even hotel rooms, making that at least their waist-up dressing is on point.

**BRUSHING SCAMS**

In September, Amazon stopped shipping seeds across the United States, because of biosecurity concerns over people across the country receiving

mysterious packets of seeds from China, seeds that they had never ordered. The public has been warned that if they receive seeds, they should not plant them and report them to the authorities. Nobody is sure what is going on here, if it is a prank, a mistake, a scam or something more clandestine, but at present it seems to be a brushing scam gone haywire. A brushing scam is a method to boost a particular vendor's credibility on an ecommerce platform. How it works is that the vendor generates fake orders, or simply orders with the names of other people. Then, these orders are delivered in the form of cheap low value goods, that may or may not actually be the product being sold. The shipping of the package is important for the ecommerce site to consider it as a legitimate order. At times, even empty boxes may be shipped. These fake orders are then given five star reviews, which increases the visibility of the vendor on the ecommerce platform, and allows them to get more real orders. These fake orders are a way to boost “customer” ratings.

**HYPE HOUSES**

Because of the pandemic, the rich have retreated to their protective bubbles, isolated from the cares of a world in turmoil. Groups of Gen Z social media stars are forming collectives known as Hype Houses, where they come together to exploit their collective social media standings, and create content for their millions of followers on platforms such as TikTok, YouTube and Instagram. This simplifies the logistics problem that goes with taking the glossy shots